Christopher Tran

Network Administration | Enterprise Infrastructure | Fortinet | Hybrid Cloud
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Summary

Network Engineer backed by 8+ years in technical operations and IT support, with the last 4+ years dedicated to multi-site network engineering across 70+ locations and 2 on-premises data centers. Adept at administering Fortinet security appliances (FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer), hybrid Active Directory/Entra ID, and enterprise MDM solutions. Brings a well-rounded background in escalations, full-cycle deployments, and 24/7 operational continuity. Holds **CompTIA IT Operations Specialist (CIOS), Network+, A+, and ITIL 4 Foundation** certifications while completing an M.S. in IT Management at WGU.

Experience

Auto-Chlor System — Mountain View, CA

Network Engineer — 2025 – Present

- **Enterprise Network Architecture & Security:** Oversee network operations and perimeter security across 70+ remote branch locations and 2 on-premises data centers, administering FortiGate firewalls, FortiManager centralized policies, and FortiAnalyzer log telemetry.
- **End-to-End Project Ownership & Delegation:** Direct multi-site infrastructure deployments from scope to delivery, actively delegating technical tasks and coordinating junior engineers' project timelines to ensure milestone execution without compromising day-to-day help desk and operational support SLAs.
- **Branch Surveillance Infrastructure Deployment:** Architected and deployed an in-house surveillance DVR solution across nearly a dozen satellite branches using dedicated mini PCs running Amcrest Surveillance Pro, integrated with Windows Remote Desktop Services for secure remote management.
- **Strategic Sourcing & Contract Lifecycle Management:** Led carrier contract negotiations alongside the CTO and IT Manager, optimizing telecom operating expenditures (OpEx) by 40% and maximizing enterprise purchasing power to procure high-tier Samsung Galaxy S-series hardware at near-zero capital outlay.
- **VPN & Hybrid Cloud Connectivity:** Implemented resilient site-to-site IPsec and SSL VPN tunnels, bridging on-premises data centers with hybrid cloud services while maintaining zero-downtime cutovers during network hardware upgrades.
- **Operational Leadership & Escalation:** Serve as the senior technical escalation point for complex L3 routing, switching, and firewall security incidents across the 11-person IT department, mentoring junior staff and establishing standard operating procedures (SOPs).

Junior Network Engineer — 2022 – 2025

- **Enterprise Network & Security:** Configured Fortinet network security devices (FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer) and resolved multi-site routing, VPN, and TCP/IP connectivity issues across 70+ branch locations.
- **Incident Escalation & On-Call:** Delivered prompt tier-1/tier-2 operational support, participating in a 24/7/365 on-call rotation to resolve critical network outages and service tickets within SLA targets.
- **Identity & Systems Administration:** Managed hybrid Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID environments, automating routine account provisioning, permissions, and system maintenance using PowerShell and Bash.
- **Endpoint & Device Fleet Deployment:** Streamlined mobile device management (MDM) lifecycle for field operations using Samsung Knox, onboarding and configuring phones and tablets for enterprise-wide rollout.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Partnered with Senior Network Engineers to evaluate system architecture changes and assisted Software Engineers with application testing and remote deployment validation.

Santa Clara County — San Jose, CA

Associate IT Service Desk Specialist — 2020 – 2022

Provided IT support for the Registrar of Voters, specializing in the configuration and certification of the county's electronic poll book system. Deployed and individually certified 1,200 iPads with election software, voter information files, and paired Bluetooth printers for distribution across 100+ voting centers countywide. Delivered on-site technical support and end-user training at vote centers throughout the county.

Amazon.com — California

3P Problem Solver — 2018 – 2020

Rapidly promoted to a lead role within 2 months of hire, coordinating floor operations and supporting the Area Manager with staffing and daily prioritization. Oversaw time-sensitive order fulfillment in a high-volume warehouse environment, providing guidance and support to coworkers to maintain efficiency and meet productivity targets.

Projects

Home Lab

Repurposed a decommissioned Dell PowerEdge R730 donated by Auto-Chlor System into a personal enterprise-grade lab environment running Proxmox. Use it to simulate network topologies, experiment with virtualized infrastructure, and explore technologies outside of production — bridging hands-on curiosity with real-world engineering practice.

Formula 1 Wiki

Administrator and contributor to the comprehensive Formula 1 wiki on Fandom. Managing content, community guidelines, and technical aspects of one of the largest F1 knowledge bases online. Helping maintain accurate and up-to-date information about Formula 1 racing, teams, drivers, and historical data for fans worldwide.

Education

WGU — Master of Science
IT Management
Online • Expected 2027

UC San Diego — Bachelor of Science
Math-Computer Science
La Jolla, CA • 2018

Foothill College — Associate in Science
Computer Science
Los Altos Hills, CA • 2015

Certifications

IT Operations Specialist — 2026
CompTIA

Network+ — 2026
CompTIA

A+ — 2025
CompTIA

ITIL 4 Foundation — 2025
PeopleCert

Google IT Support — 2022
Coursera

Skills

Core Competencies
Project Management · Cross-functional Collaboration · IT Service Delivery · Documentation · End-User Training

Infrastructure
On-premises Windows Server, Data Center Management, Hyper-V, Proxmox

Firewalls & Security
Fortinet, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer, Fortigate

Identity & Directory
Active Directory (Hybrid), Microsoft Entra ID, Cloudflare Zero Trust

Collaboration & Productivity
Microsoft 365, Teams, SharePoint

MDM
Samsung Knox, Jamf, Microsoft Intune